ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 3 · WRITING · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 60

Marking guideline for the Academic Central Grade 8 English First Additional Language paper 3 · writing.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education marking guideline.

How to mark: Writing is marked with the rubrics below, not with ticks. Read the whole piece first, then decide on the level for each criterion. Learners may interpret topics in their own way as long as the writing is relevant.

SECTION A: ESSAY – RUBRIC (30 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content and planning (18)	15–18: Original, mature ideas; fully on topic; vivid, well-chosen detail; strong introduction and conclusion	11–14: Relevant, well-developed ideas; good detail	8–10: Mostly relevant; some detail; ideas sometimes predictable	5–7: Ideas thin or repeated; parts not on topic	0–4: Hardly on topic; very few ideas
Language, style and editing (9)	8–9: Varied vocabulary, sentence types and figurative language; very few errors	6–7: Good vocabulary; few errors	5: Simple but clear; some errors	3–4: Limited vocabulary; many errors make reading hard	0–2: Errors make the meaning unclear
Structure (3)	3: Well-organised paragraphs with topic sentences; logical flow; correct length	2: Paragraphs mostly used; some ideas out of order		0–1: No paragraphs; disorganised; far too short or long	

1.1 **A moment that changed my life** – a clear story of ONE moment (not a whole life story), with background, the event itself, a climax and a reflection on how and why it changed the writer. [30]

1.2 **The place where I feel most at home** – a description, not a story. Look for vivid sense images, figurative language (similes, metaphors, personification) and the feelings the place gives the writer. [30]

1.3 **Social media** – a clear position in the introduction; at least THREE reasons, each in its own paragraph with examples or evidence (e.g. cyberbullying, addiction, sleep, self-image / connection, learning, creativity); a counter-argument for higher marks; a conclusion that restates the position. [30]

1.4 **"Every expert was once a beginner"** – the writer explains the meaning (everyone starts without skill; experts became good through practice, mistakes and patience) and supports it with personal examples or examples of others; reflective tone. [30]

1.5 The story MUST begin with the given words. Credit suspense, a clear plot (conflict, climax, resolution) and a believable setting at school. Deduct from Content if the opening is missing or changed. [30]

TOTAL SECTION A: [30]

SECTION B: LONGER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT – RUBRIC (20 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content, planning and format (12)	10–12: All requirements of the task covered; correct format throughout; register (tone) suits the audience	8–9: Most requirements; format mostly correct	6–7: Some requirements; format partly correct	4–5: Few requirements; format mostly wrong	0–3: Task not understood; no format
Language, style and editing (8)	7–8: Very few errors; suitable, varied vocabulary	5–6: Few errors	4: Some errors; meaning clear	2–3: Many errors	0–1: Meaning unclear

2.1 **Formal letter** – Format: writer's address and date (top right); the principal's title and the school's address (left); "Dear Sir/Madam" or "Dear Mr/Ms …"; subject line (e.g. "REQUEST TO START A GRADE 8 HOMEWORK CLUB"); body in paragraphs; "Yours faithfully" (or "Yours sincerely" if the name is used); signature and full name. Content: the need for the club, when and where it will meet, who will supervise, how it will help learners, a polite request for permission. Formal register. [20]

2.2 **Speech** – Format: a heading is optional; a greeting to the audience ("Good morning, Ms …, and fellow learners"); introduction; body; conclusion with thanks. Content: thanks for the votes; at least TWO specific plans; a call to the class to work together. Register: friendly but respectful; uses direct address ("you", "we") and rhetorical devices. [20]

2.3 **Newspaper article** – Format: catchy headline; by-line (writer's name); optional dateline; short paragraphs; third person, past tense. Content: answers who, what, when, where, why and how; facts such as the number of bags of rubbish collected; at least one quotation from a participant; a closing sentence about the effect or future plans. [20]

TOTAL SECTION B: [20]

SECTION C: SHORTER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT – RUBRIC (10 MARKS)

Criterion	Outstanding	Good	Adequate	Weak	Not achieved
Content, planning and format (6)	6: All information; correct, clear format	5: Most information; format correct	4: Some information missing	2–3: Much missing; poor format	0–1: Task not understood
Language, style and editing (4)	4: Almost no errors	3: Few errors	2: Some errors		0–1: Many errors

3.1 **Notice** – the word NOTICE or a clear heading; name of the school or club; what (first meeting), when (date and time), where (venue); who may attend; what to bring; contact person; name/position of the person issuing the notice and date. [10]

3.2 **Instructions** – a title; a list of what is needed (ingredients and utensils); numbered steps in the correct order; imperative verbs ("Take", "Spread"); short, clear sentences; a safety or hygiene tip (e.g. wash your hands, be careful with the knife). [10]

3.3 **Diary entry** – date at the top; first person; past tense for events; personal, informal tone; events of the day and the writer's feelings and reflections about the results. [10]

TOTAL SECTION C: [10]

TOTAL: 60

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE